

# THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Wall Street is rolling** into the new year firing on all cylinders after the nation's biggest banks had one of the strongest years on record in 2025. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** plans to propose that the nation's largest power grid operator, PJM, hold an emergency auction in which tech companies would bid to have new power plants built. **A2**

◆ **TSMC plans to spend** a record amount, as much as \$56 billion, this year to feed the world's appetite for chips. **B2**

◆ **Semiconductor stocks** rallied after TSMC posted a record profit for the fourth quarter, helping to lift the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq by 0.3%, 0.6% and 0.2%, respectively. **B9**

◆ **The criminal probe** into Fed Chair Jerome Powell threatens to upend the contest over whom Trump will choose to replace him as it enters its final stretch. **A1**

◆ **Philadelphia Fed** President Anna Paulson backed Powell in his resistance to pressure from the Justice Department and said there was no hurry to reduce interest rates again. **A2**

◆ **Ford and BYD** are discussing a partnership in which the American carmaker would buy batteries from the Chinese for some of Ford's hybrid-vehicle models. **B1**

◆ **Kathleen Kennedy** is stepping down as president of Lucasfilm, the Disney division that makes Star Wars films and TV shows, and will be succeeded by Dave Filoni. **B1**

◆ **Verizon said its** hourslong outage Wednesday was tied to a software update and offered wireless customers affected by it a \$20 account credit. **B2**

Worldwide

◆ **Prosecutors charged** two gamblers with allegedly conspiring with dozens of basketball players to rig games ranging from U.S. colleges to the top professional league in China. **A1**

◆ **Trump was advised** that a large-scale strike against Iran was unlikely to make the government fall and could spark a wider conflict. **A9**

◆ **Trump threatened** to invoke the Insurrection Act, which could allow him to deploy the military inside the U.S. in response to widening protests in Minnesota. **A3**

◆ **Federal immigration** agents targeted construction workers traveling to the site of a Meta Platforms data center being built in Louisiana. **A3**

◆ **An appeals court** dealt a blow to Columbia University protester Mahmoud Khalil, unwinding the decision that freed him from immigration detention last year. **A4**

◆ **Venezuelan opposition** leader Maria Corina Machado met Trump at the White House and presented him with her Nobel Peace Prize, which he accepted. **A6**

◆ **U.S. Marines** and sailors dispatched from the USS Gerald R. Ford aircraft carrier in the Caribbean Sea seized a sixth oil tanker. **A6**

◆ **Trump urged Congress** to prioritize healthcare this year, endorsing proposals that come as the Republican Party comes under pressure over rising costs. **A3**

◆ **The FDA quietly removed** webpages saying cellphones aren't dangerous as the HHS launches a study on cellphone radiation. **A4**

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## Europe Reinforces Greenland to Deter U.S.



**NO THAW:** U.S. NATO allies, including France, Sweden and Germany, are building up military and diplomatic assets on the Arctic island, a semiautonomous territory of Denmark. Above, a Royal Danish Navy vessel patrols near Nuuk on Thursday. **A6**

## Probe Into Powell Complicates Trump Search for Fed Successor

Backlash to inquiry threatens to rouse Senate opposition if loyalist is chosen

The criminal investigation into Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell threatens to upend the contest over whom

By Nick Timiraos, Siobhan Hughes and Josh Dawsey

President Trump will choose to replace him as it enters its final stretch.

The episode is creating new obstacles on Capitol Hill and raising hard questions about whether any nominee can be seen as independent—tension that was always present but is now much harder to ignore. Trump has made clear he prizes loyalty in his pick, but the Justice Department probe—which Powell said was part of a broader pressure campaign to get the Fed to lower rates—threatens to make that quality a liability.

The backlash on Capitol Hill could force that pick to walk a gauntlet in any confirmation process this spring. The nomi-

nee would have to avoid upsetting Trump with statements that question his efforts to challenge the Fed without provoking concerns from lawmakers or market participants that they're too close to Trump to be credible.

"Trump is making it very difficult by saying he refuses to appoint anyone who doesn't agree with him and is not going to do what he wants," said Janet Yellen, a former Fed chair and Treasury secretary. "So you start with that, which undermines a person's credibility."

In a sign of some lawmak-

ers' unease, two Republican senators—Thom Tillis of North Carolina and Lisa Murkowski of Alaska—said they won't vote for any nominee until the probe is resolved.

"I wouldn't consider my mother for the post under the current conditions because we've got to resolve this matter," Tillis said earlier this week. "It's foundational to making decisions about the board going forward."

Tillis, who sits on the Sen-

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◆ **Paulson backs Fed chair, says cut can wait..... A2**

## Basketball Scandal Broadens With New Charges

By JARED DIAMOND AND LOUISE RADNOFSKY

PHILADELPHIA—Federal prosecutors on Thursday charged a pair of gamblers with allegedly conspiring with dozens of basketball players to rig games ranging from U.S. colleges to the top professional league in China, in one of the most sprawling gambling cases in the history of U.S. sports.

The case that emerged in 2024 appeared limited to a fringe National Basketball Association forward in Toronto, but the allegations expanded to pull in an NBA head coach and a star player, with connections to fixed poker games and organized crime. Then it grew again.

"This," said U.S. Attorney David Metcalf for the Eastern District of Pennsylvania, "was a massive scheme that enveloped the world of college basketball." In total, the government alleges that at least 39 players on 17 Division I teams manipulated about 29 contests in 2024 and 2025 in places such as Moon Township, Pa., and Hattiesburg, Miss. The schools alleged to be involved feature a Big East stalwart (DePaul) and two programs that reached the NCAA tournament last March (Robert Morris and Alabama State). Four of the players charged appeared in games this week, including one who scored 21 points for Kennesaw State as recently as Wednesday night.

Taken together, the charges in Thursday's indictment offered the latest reminder of how pervasive game-rigging has become in the era of legal

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### INSIDE



#### MANSION

A generation's transfer of wealth is reshaping the luxury home market. **M1**

## ‘A Massacre Happened’: 24 Hours That Bloodied Iran

Authorities shut down the internet on Jan. 8 as protests against the regime grew. Then the large-scale killings began.

By BENOIT FAUCON AND MARGHERITA STANCATI

Robina Aminian was passionate about fashion, posting images of herself on Instagram wearing the dresses she hand-embroidered.

She was also passionate about politics. On Jan. 8 the fashion student finished her class at Tehran's women-only Shariati College at around 7 p.m. and joined a group of antigovernment protesters not far from campus.

Iranians had been demonstrating for over a week, but Aminian knew that day was going to be different. The protests had been growing in size and expanding to more cit-

ies, with calls for regime change becoming louder. President Trump had threatened to intervene if security forces started shooting. Adding to the growing momentum, Reza Pahlavi, the exiled son of the deposed shah, had urged Iranians to pour onto the streets at 8 p.m., the start of the Iranian weekend.

Aminian wouldn't survive the night. "She was a girl full of enthusiasm for life and a lover of design and fashion whose dreams were buried by the violence of the oppres-

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◆ **Trump was warned off attack on Iran..... A9**  
◆ **Crackdown quells protests for now..... A9**

## Seeking Answers on Venezuela, They Turned to ‘Jack Ryan’

Fans say a 2019 episode of the show tells you all you need to know about current events

By TARA WEISS

When Thalia Toha wasn't sure how to answer her teenage daughter's question about what just happened in Venezuela, she stumbled on the perfect explainer: a scene from a 2019 episode of "Tom Clancy's Jack Ryan."

The clip features John Krasinski as CIA analyst Jack Ryan asking a packed lecture hall: "What would you assume is the most major threat on the world stage?" Audience members answered China, Russia and North Korea until Ryan explained it's Venezuela, thanks to its oil and mineral-rich land and corrupt strongman leader who tanked the economy.

That scene has gone viral and prompted many to ask

whether its creators predicted the future six years before American troops captured Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro and brought him to the U.S. to face federal drug trafficking charges. One Instagram reel of the clip got 40 million views in two days and has fueled a resurgence of interest in the Prime Video series, which ended after season four in 2023. More than a week after the news, "Tom Clancy's Jack Ryan" remains in the top 10 most watched shows on the Amazon.com streaming service.

For Toha, it was a succinct entrypoint on the complex subject for her teenage daughter.

"The 'Jack Ryan' clip doesn't just help give the

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